

Daily Shipping Trade Advisory — Sattva Global Logistics

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Executive Summary

The Strait of Hormuz crisis has escalated critically as of 8 May 2026, with the US–Iran ceasefire under severe strain and commercial vessel transits at approximately 5% of pre-crisis levels — no transits recorded since 4 May. CMA CGM's container vessel *San Antonio*, which departed Khalifa Port (UAE) on 2 May bound for Mundra, India, was attacked in the Strait on 5 May with crew injuries reported and structural damage confirmed. A separate explosion struck HMM's cargo vessel *Namu* at anchor off Umm Al Quwain, UAE, on 4 May. On 7 May, US and Iranian military forces exchanged fire in the Strait, with each side claiming the other fired first. President Trump subsequently paused "Project Freedom" — the US naval escort operation for stranded vessels — citing diplomatic progress; however, the naval blockade of Hormuz remains in effect. Carrier booking suspensions for all India–Gulf destinations remain in force across Maersk, MSC, Hapag-Lloyd, CMA CGM, COSCO, and ONE. In parallel, Maersk has announced a Peak Season Surcharge (PSS) effective 21 May 2026 for Indian Subcontinent to US and Canada West Coast trades, and a revised Emergency Contingency Surcharge (ECS) for India–Latin America takes effect 10 May 2026.

Key Developments Today

- **CMA CGM San Antonio attacked en route to Mundra** — vessel (Maltese-flagged) was struck in the Strait of Hormuz on 5 May while transiting from UAE to Mundra port; crew injured, vessel damaged. Signals persistent live risk even for partial Hormuz transits.
- **HMM Namu explosion (4 May)** — cargo vessel struck by suspected drone or sea mine while at anchor off Umm Al Quwain, UAE; all 24 crew safe.
- **US–Iran military exchange in Hormuz (7 May)** — both sides fired, each blaming the other; ceasefire technically holds but is extremely fragile. No commercial transits since 4 May (5% of pre-conflict levels).
- **US halts "Project Freedom"** — Trump paused the naval escort convoy initiative on 5 May, citing negotiation progress; Hormuz naval blockade remains in effect.
- **Carrier booking freeze continues** — Maersk, MSC, CMA CGM, Hapag-Lloyd, COSCO, ONE all maintain suspension of India–Gulf bookings with no resumption date published.
- **Maersk PSS (India → US/Canada West Coast) effective 21 May 2026** — applicable to non-spot bookings; exporters should request updated freight quotes now.
- **Maersk ECS (India → Latin America) effective 10 May 2026** — USD 1,200 per 20ft / USD 1,000 per 40ft for NW India & Pakistan origin cargo to WCSA, Caribbean, and Central America.

Carrier-Specific Updates

CMA CGM — Status: **DISRUPTED**

CMA CGM container vessel *San Antonio* (Maltese-flagged), which departed Khalifa Port UAE on 2 May bound for Mundra, India, was attacked in the Strait of Hormuz on 5 May 2026. Crew injuries reported and vessel structurally damaged. 14 CMA CGM vessels remain stranded in the Gulf. All Gulf bookings remain suspended. CMA CGM has reverted Gulf-routed services to Cape of Good Hope routing.

Source: *Seatrade Maritime, Al Arabiya, Oman Observer* — 5–6 May 2026

Maersk — Status: **DISRUPTED**

Booking suspension for Indian Subcontinent to Upper Gulf destinations (UAE, Bahrain, Qatar, Iraq, Kuwait, Dammam, Jubail) remains in force as of Operational Update 29 (4 May 2026). New PSS for India/ISC & Middle East to US and Canada West Coast is effective **21 May 2026** for non-spot bookings. Revised ECS for India/ISC to West Coast Latin America effective **10 May 2026**: USD 1,200 per 20ft container / USD 1,000 per 40ft container (NW India & Pakistan origin).

Source: *maersk.com Operational Update 29* — 4 May 2026; *maersk.com PSS advisory* — 20 Apr 2026

Hapag-Lloyd — Status: **DISRUPTED**

War risk surcharge of **USD 1,500/TEU** and **USD 3,500/reefer and special** in effect for all cargo moving to, from, or through the Gulf region. Emergency Fuel Surcharge (EFS) also applicable. No timeline set for resumption of Gulf services — Hapag-Lloyd has stated a decision will be made only once crew, cargo, and asset safety can be guaranteed. Q2 2026 local charges update covering India routes in effect from April 2026.

Source: *hapag-lloyd.com* — March 2026 EFS circular; *tth-co.com surcharge guide*

HMM — Status: **DISRUPTED**

HMM cargo vessel *Namu* was struck by an explosion (suspected drone or drifting sea mine) while at anchor off Umm Al Quwain, UAE, on 4 May 2026. All 24 crew reported safe. HMM Gulf services remain under restriction. This is the second major carrier incident in the Hormuz zone in recent weeks.

Source: *indiashippingnews.com* — 4 May 2026

MSC — Status: **SUSPENDED**

MSC suspended all worldwide bookings to Middle East destinations effective 1 March 2026; suspension remains in force. MSC has arranged feeder connections to the Gulf for containers discharged at Indian and Sri Lankan ports (Colombo, Mundra) as interim measures. No resumption date published.

Source: *rwfreight.co.uk, theloadstar.com* — March 2026

COSCO — Status: **SUSPENDED**

COSCO suspended new bookings on 4 March 2026 for shipments to and from UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, and Saudi Arabia. Suspension remains active with no resumption announcement as of 8 May 2026.

Source: *mightyshipping.com* — March 2026

Surcharge Table

Carrier	Surcharge Name	Trade Lane	Effective Date	Amount (20ft/TEU)	Amount (40ft/FEU)	Currency	
Maersk	Peak Season Surcharge (PSS)	ISC & ME → US & Canada West Coast	21 May 2026	Request quote	Request quote	USD	mae 202
Maersk	Emergency Contingency Surcharge (ECS)	NW India & Pakistan → WCSA / Caribbean / Central America	10 May 2026	USD 1,200	USD 1,000	USD	ind
CMA CGM	Emergency Conflict Surcharge	India/ISC → Gulf / Middle East	Mar 2026 (ongoing)	USD 2,000	USD 3,000	USD	the
Hapag-Lloyd	War Risk Surcharge (WRS)	All origins ↔ Gulf / Middle East	Mar 2026 (ongoing)	USD 1,500	USD 3,500 (reefer/special)	USD	tth-c
Hapag-Lloyd	Emergency Fuel Surcharge (EFS)	India/ISC → Gulf / Middle East	Mar 2026 (ongoing)	Not clearly specified in source	Not clearly specified in source	USD	hap

Trade Impact on Indian Exporters

Exporters shipping FCL from Mundra, JNPT (Nhava Sheva), Pipavav, and Chennai to Gulf destinations face a complete booking freeze across all major carriers with no confirmed resumption timeline — and the situation worsened this week with the CMA CGM San Antonio attack while en route to Mundra, which signals continued active risk even for vessels attempting limited Hormuz transits. Exporters must treat India–Gulf sea freight as operationally unavailable for new cargo until the Hormuz situation stabilises; air freight or bonded warehousing in transshipment hubs should be evaluated for time-critical goods. Those routing cargo to Europe via Suez should confirm whether their carrier is currently on Cape of Good Hope routing (adding 8–12 days and significant fuel costs) — all major carriers remain on Cape routing as of 8 May. Exporters with US/Canada West Coast bookings under Maersk non-spot contracts should request an updated freight quote immediately, as the PSS effective 21 May will apply to the price calculation date of the first water leg at booking confirmation. For India–Latin America cargo under Maersk, the revised ECS of USD 1,200 per 20ft / USD 1,000 per 40ft applies from 10 May — factor this into contract pricing before finalising export invoicing.

Recommended Contingency Actions for Indian Exporters

1. **Treat India–Gulf as suspended** — Do not accept new export orders with Gulf port delivery commitments until carriers issue an unambiguous resumption notice. Communicate proactively with buyers in UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, and Saudi Arabia.
2. **Reconfirm routing on all booked Europe shipments** — Contact your freight forwarder to confirm whether your vessel is on Cape of Good Hope routing or Suez. Budget for 8–12 additional transit days and elevated fuel surcharges vs. pre-crisis rates.
3. **Request updated freight quotes before 10 May and 21 May** — The Maersk ECS for India–WCLA applies from 10 May and the PSS for India–US West Coast from 21 May. Both affect pricing calculation dates. Lock in quotes before these dates wherever possible.
4. **Check cargo and war risk insurance cover** — Policies written before the Hormuz crisis may have updated exclusions for Gulf routing. Verify that your marine cargo policy covers Cape-routed shipments and any transshipment at Colombo or Salalah.
5. **Monitor the US–Iran negotiations closely** — The ceasefire is fragile. Any deal that includes Hormuz reopening would trigger rapid — and chaotic — carrier booking resumption. Position your freight forwarder to secure early capacity at that moment.

Sources Referenced

- Maersk Advisory — Middle East Operational Update 29: <https://www.maersk.com/news/articles/2026/05/04/middle-east-operational-update-29>
- Maersk PSS — ISC to US/Canada West Coast: <https://www.maersk.com/news/articles/2026/04/20/pss-indian-subcontinent-middle-east-us-canada-west-coast>
- India Shipping News — Maersk ECS ISC-WCLA: <https://indiashippingnews.com/maersk-revises-emergency-contingency-surcharges-for-isc-wcla-trade/>
- India Shipping News — HMM Namu attack: <https://indiashippingnews.com/hmm-namu-a-cargo-ship-hit-by-explosion-off-uae/>
- CMA CGM San Antonio attack: <https://www.seatrade-maritime.com/security/cma-cgm-container-ship-attacked-in-strait-of-hormuz>
- The Loadstar — Gulf booking halts & surcharges: <https://theloadstar.com/gulf-conflict-chaos-carriers-slap-hefty-surcharges-and-halt-india-middle-east-bookings/>
- Hapag-Lloyd EFS / War Risk Surcharge: <https://www.hapag-lloyd.com/en/services-information/news/2026/03/emergency-fuel-surcharge--efs--implementation.html>
- Al Jazeera — Hormuz ceasefire and Iran announcement: <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/5/6/french-container-ship-struck-in-latest-escalation-at-strait-of-hormuz>
- CNBC — US–Iran fire exchange: <https://www.cnbc.com/2026/05/07/iran-war-hormuz-strait-ceasefire-trump.html>
- NPR — Trump halts Project Freedom: <https://www.npr.org/2026/05/05/nx-s1-5811770/iran-war-updates>

This advisory is produced by Sattva Global Logistics for informational purposes based on publicly available carrier advisories and industry reporting. Exporters should independently verify all surcharge rates and routing decisions with their freight forwarder before finalising bookings. Situation may change rapidly given active geopolitical developments.